Types of Sentinel (Never) Events

Surgical/Invasive Procedure Event

- Surgery or other invasive procedure performed on the wrong site
- Surgery or other invasive procedure performed on the wrong patient
- Wrong surgical or other invasive procedure performed on a patient
- Unintended retention of a foreign object in a patient after surgery or other invasive procedure
- Intraoperative or immediately postoperative/post-procedure death in an American Society of Anesthesiologists Class I patient

Product/Device Event

- Patient death or serious injury associated with the use of contaminated drugs, devices, or biologics provided by the healthcare setting
- Patient death or serious injury associated with the use or function of a device in patient care, in which the device is used for functions other than as intended
- Patient death or serious injury associated with intravascular air embolism that occurs while being cared for in a healthcare setting

Patient Protection Event

- Discharge or release of a patient/resident of any age, who is unable to make decisions, to other than an authorized person
- Patient death or serious injury associated with patient elopement (disappearance)
- Patient suicide, attempted suicide, or self-harm that results in serious injury, while being cared for in a healthcare setting

Care Management Event

- Patient death or serious injury from a medication error (e.g., errors of 7 med rights)
- Patient death or serious injury associated with unsafe admin blood products
- Maternal or neonatal death or serious injury associated with labor or delivery in a low-risk pregnancy while being cared for in a healthcare setting

- Patient death or serious injury from a fall while being cared for in a healthcare setting
- Any stage 3, stage 4, and unstageable pressure ulcers acquired after admission
- Artificial insemination with the wrong donor sperm or wrong egg
- Patient death or serious injury resulting from failure to follow up or communicate results

Environmental Event

- Patient or staff death or serious disability associated with an electric shock in the course of a patient care process in a healthcare setting
- Any incident in which a line designated for oxygen or other gas to be delivered to a patient contains no gas, the wrong gas, or is contaminated by toxic substances
- Patient or staff death or serious injury associated with a burn incurred from any source in the course of a patient care process in a healthcare setting
- Patient death or serious injury associated with the use of physical restraints or bedrails while being cared for in a healthcare setting

Radiologic Event

- Death or serious injury of a patient or staff associated with introduction of a metallic object into the MRI area

Potential Criminal Event

- Any instance of care ordered by or provided by someone impersonating a physician, nurse, pharmacist, or other licensed health care provider
- Abduction of a patient/resident of any age
- Sexual abuse/assault on a patient or staff member within or on the grounds of a healthcare setting
- Death or serious injury of a patient or staff member resulting from a physical assault (i.e., battery) that occurs within or on the grounds of a healthcare setting